Skill – Persuasion (Charisma) · SRD 5.2.1

Persuasion is used to **convince with tact and sincerity**: negotiate, calm, compromise. It uses a **Charisma (Persuasion)** check via the **Influence** action.

The creature's attitude (Hostile, Indifferent, Friendly) sets the **DC**.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. **Charisma (Persuasion)** check.
2. **Influence** action.
3. DC by attitude: Friendly < Indifferent < Hostile.
4. Works if the request is reasonable.

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 groups Persuasion, Deception, Intimidation and Performance under the Influence action.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The SRD doesn't say whether success forces the decision. Fix: the NPC decides, but their attitude improves a step.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can play out the NPC's reaction rather than announce the result.

Step 1 – Announce:

The player says what they ask and how they speak.

Step 2 – Attitude:

Hostile, Indifferent or Friendly: it modifies the DC.

Step 3 – Set the DC:

Friendly DC 10; Indifferent DC 15; Hostile DC 20.

Step 4 – Roll:

1d20 + Charisma + proficiency.

Step 5 – Resolve:

Success: the NPC agrees or their attitude improves; failure: they refuse.

Example: Elora asks an Indifferent guard to let her through (DC 15). She rolls 16: he lets her pass.

⚠ Common questions:

Persuasion or Deception?

Persuasion: honest; Deception: lying.

Does it force obedience?

No: it influences, it doesn't compel.

Against an enemy in combat?

Possible but high DC (Hostile).

Must I speak?

Yes, or share a language.

How many times?

A success changes attitude; pushing can worsen it.

Charm magic?

Persuasion isn't magic.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Unreasonable request

An absurd request. **Option**: automatic failure.

Attitude

Change attitude in one roll. **Option**: one step per success.

Pushing

Retrying. **Option**: Disadvantage.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Influence

Persuasion, Deception, Intimidation and Performance use the Influence action.

Attitude

The NPC's attitude sets the DC.

No compulsion

It influences, it doesn't force.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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